US Top 50 Playlist Analytics

Executive Summary

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Atlantic Recording Corporation · US Top 50 Playlist Analysis

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Prepared for: Programme and funding stakeholders

Generated 2026-10-24

Overview

This report summarises an analysis of 555 daily snapshots of the United States Top 50 streaming playlist (2024-05-18 to 2025-11-27), covering 943 unique songs by 297 artists.

Key Findings

1. **Chart longevity**: the median song stays on the chart for 7 days. A small group of highly persistent tracks (up to 536 days) dominates cumulative chart presence.
2. **Popularity vs rank**: playlist position and popularity score are only weakly correlated (r = -0.094). Rank is shaped by factors beyond the popularity metric.
3. **Explicit content**: explicit songs account for 47.9% of chart entries and perform on par with non-explicit songs. No content penalty.
4. **Singles vs albums**: singles show a slight performance edge over album tracks on both popularity and average rank.
5. **Duration**: song length has no measurable effect on chart success.
6. **Artist concentration**: the top artists maintain multiple songs on the chart simultaneously, accumulating disproportionate visibility.

Recommendations

- Invest in **catalogue depth**: artists with multiple concurrent chart entries gain compounding visibility.
- Track **rank volatility and trend scores** to catch songs on the decline early and reallocate promotion resources.
- **Do not restrict explicit releases** on performance grounds — the data shows no penalty.
- Time releases to **low-churn windows** identified in the turnover analysis.
- Use the **interactive Streamlit dashboard** for ongoing monitoring and artist-specific deep dives.

Methodology

All results were generated by an automated Python pipeline that loads the raw CSV, validates data quality, computes derived KPIs (Days on Chart, Rank Volatility, Popularity Trend Score, Artist Dominance Index), and produces both this summary and a full research paper with 9 figures. The Streamlit dashboard reads the same artefacts, ensuring consistency between the written report and the interactive tool.